

Weather and environment

Speaking Part 1

Imagine that you are preparing a project with your friend. You have found some interesting material for the presentation and you want to read this text to your friend. You have 1.5 minutes to read the text silently, then be ready to read it out aloud. You will not have more than 1.5 minutes to read it.

Russia is a vast country with a diverse climate, but in general, the weather is characterised by long, cold winters and short, mild summers. The coldest temperature ever recorded in Russia was -67.7°C in the village of Verkhoyansk in 1892, and the highest temperature ever recorded was $+44.6^{\circ}\text{C}$ in the village of Orai in 2010. The winter months can be particularly harsh in Russia, with heavy snowfall and freezing temperatures. The highest snowfall ever recorded in Russia was in November 1971 in the village of Kolyvan, where 1.5 meters of snow fell in 24 hours. On the other hand, summers can be mild to warm in some regions, with temperatures reaching up to 30°C in some areas. Russia is known for its extreme weather conditions, both in the cold and hot side. Travelling in Russia can be pleasant with comfortable weather during the spring, summer, and autumn months, making it ideal for outdoor activities and exploring cities.

Speaking Part 2. Task 1

Study the advertisement.

A Magic Camping Trip



You are considering joining a camping trip with environmental scientists from all over the world and you'd like to get more information about this trip. In 1.5 minutes you are to ask four direct questions to find out about the following:

1. date when it starts;
2. weather conditions this time of year;
3. equipment rental;
4. where to buy food and drinks while camping.

You have 20 seconds to ask each question.

Speaking Part 2. Task 2

Study the advertisement.

Become a member of "Save the planet" now!



You are considering entering a local environmental organisation and you'd like to get more information about this. In 1.5 minutes you are to ask four direct questions to find out about the following:

1. location;
2. local or international campaigns;
3. salary
4. opening hours

You have 20 seconds to ask each question.

Speaking Part 3. Task 1

You are going to give an interview. You have to answer five questions.

Give full answers to the questions (2-3 sentences).

Remember that you have 40 seconds to answer each question.

Tapescript for task 3.

Interviewer: Hello everybody! It's *Teenagers Round the World* Channel. Our guest today is a teenager from Russia and we are going to discuss environmental problems. We'd like to know our guest's point of view on this issue. Please answer five questions. So, let's get started.

Interviewer: Are you environmentally friendly?

Student: _____

Interviewer: What are the biggest problems facing our environment?

Student: _____

Interviewer: Would you give money to or actively campaign for environmental causes?

Student: _____

Interviewer: Why are environmental issues important?

Student: _____

Interviewer: Do people in your country protect the environment?

Student: _____

Interviewer: Thank you very much for your interview.

Suggested answers for Speaking Part 2. Task 1:

1. When does the camping trip start? When is the camping trip going to take place?
2. What are the weather conditions at this time of year? What is the weather like at this time of year?
3. Can I rent any equipment if I take your tour? Is there an equipment rental near where the trip takes place?
4. Where can we buy food and drinks while camping?

Suggested answers for Speaking Part 2. Task 2:

1. What's the location of your environmental organisation? Where is your environmental organisation located?
2. Do you run local or international campaigns? Do you only conduct local campaigns or do you have international ones as well?
3. What salary can I earn if I join your environmental organisation? What salary do you pay in your environmental organisation?
4. What are the opening hours of your environmental organisation? When does your environmental organization open and close?

Suggested answers for Speaking Part 3. Task 1:

1. I think I'm rather environmentally friendly. I recycle and I always throw batteries away in special points. I also take part in school environmental activities in spring such as collecting litter in the woods.
2. I guess the biggest problem is global warming. People need to take actions to prevent our planet from getting warmer. If they don't do that, it will have devastating consequences.
3. I wouldn't give money to environmental campaigns. I don't believe that they spend it in an appropriate way. I believe people should do things themselves if they want to help. For example, they could collect litter or do recycling.
4. I think environmental issues are important because they influence our future generations. If we don't take actions now, our future children may be ill or won't enjoy the planet they live on.
5. People have started to take more actions to protect the environment than they used to. There are now picking-up points for batteries and plastic lids. Local authorities also organise events where everyone can take part.

Speaking Part 3. Task 2

You are going to give an interview. You have to answer five questions.

Give full answers to the questions (2-3 sentences).

Remember that you have 40 seconds to answer each question.

Tapescript for task 3.

Interviewer: Hello everybody! It's *Teenagers Round the World* Channel. Our guest today is a teenager from Russia and we are going to discuss the weather and environment. We'd like to know our guest's point of view on this issue. Please answer five questions. So, let's get started.

Interviewer: Do you ever worry about the environment in your local area? Why or why not?

Student: _____

Interviewer: What are the main environmental issues affecting your country at the moment? What do people do to deal with them?

Student: _____

Interviewer: How has the weather changed in your country in recent years?

Student: _____

Interviewer: Have you ever been caught in bad weather? What did you do?

Student: _____

Interviewer: What's the average temperature in your country in the summer time? How do you feel?

Student: _____

Interviewer: Thank you very much for your interview.

Speaking Part 4. Task 1

Look at the pictures. What can you see in the pictures? Say one sentence to describe each photo.



What is the difference between them that is related to the topic "Let's go green"? Try to note the difference without repeating the ideas from the description.

Mention the advantages of the two ways of environmental protection.

Mention the disadvantages of the two ways of environmental protection.

Suggested answers for Speaking Part 3. Task 2:

1. I do worry about the environment in my local area. I live in the city centre and it is hard to breathe sometimes. I think people in my neighbourhood should do something about it.
2. I think the most important one is global warming. In some areas the winters have got too cold. Besides, the level of air pollution is increasing every year. People try to use public transport. In addition, more and more people buy electric cars in my country.
3. I've already said that winters have become colder. I think summers have also become hotter, but I'm not sure.
4. Yes, I've been caught in bad weather a few times. Once a heavy rain started. I ran to the nearby café and spent almost an hour there until I was able to go out.
5. My country is huge, so the temperature differs depending on the region. In the south, it's quite warm all year long. In the north it could be very cold in winter, minus 20 or 30. In summer it's warm or hot. Up to 35 degrees Celsius. I feel all right about any weather. I don't mind extreme cold or heat.

Suggested answers for Speaking Part 4. Task 1:

In the first picture I can see two people planting a tree, perhaps in the park. In the second picture, there's a girl holding a bag of trash\rubbish.

Difference: Although both of the pictures are related to doing things for the environment, there is a difference between them. In the first picture, the people are taking care of the environment together while in the second photo we cannot see anyone else. Perhaps the girl is doing it alone.

Advantages: There are a few advantages of these ways of environmental protection. First of all, they bring a lot of pleasure to people who do them. Besides, planting trees leads to cleaner air, since trees produce more oxygen, while collecting litter may help prevent further littering.

Disadvantages: There are also some downsides of doing these things. Planting trees is quite dirty work. Litter smells bad and this might be disgusting. Besides, there's no pay for such work.

Speaking Part 4. Task 2

Imagine that you and your friend are doing a school project "The best weather for your holidays". You have found some photos to illustrate it but for technical reasons you cannot send them now. Leave a voice message to your friend explaining your choice of the photos and sharing some ideas about the project. In 2.5 minutes be ready to:

- explain the choice of the illustrations for the project by briefly describing them and noting the differences;
- mention the advantages (1-2) of the two types of the weather;
- mention the disadvantages (1-2) of the two types of the weather;
- express your opinion on the subject of the project – which weather presented in the pictures you'd choose for holidays and why.

You will speak for not more than 3 minutes (12-15 sentences). You have to talk continuously.



Writing an email. Task 1

You have received an email message from your English-speaking pen-friend Sean:

From: Sean@mail.uk

To: Russian_friend@ege.ru

Subject: Weather

...I've been doing a project at school about weather in different parts of the world. Can you help me? What is the weather like in the place where you live? What kind of clothes do people wear in summer and in winter? I also want to know what people do to protect themselves from different weather phenomena.

I'm going to the cinema tonight...

Write an email to Sean.

In your message:

- answer his questions;
- ask **3 questions** about the film.

Write **100–140 words**.

Remember the rules of email writing.

Put the following sentences into the correct order:

1. Great news that you're going to the cinema. What film are you going to see?
How long is it? Who are the lead actors?
2. I live in Moscow and the climate isn't very severe here.
3. Best wishes,
4. Thanks for your email. I'm always happy to get a letter from you.
5. In winter it could be cold, sometimes minus 25.
6. Dear Sean,
7. It's up to 30 degrees Celsius in summer and people usually wear light clothes such as shorts, T-shirts, dresses or light jeans.
8. You asked me about weather in Russia.
9. Write back soon.
10. In Russia we build houses with good insulation to be protected from the cold and wind.
11. Lena
12. Well, it's different in different parts of the country.
13. People wear warm winter coats, trousers, woolen dresses and sweaters.
14. Governments build dams to protect some areas from flooding.

Sample answer for Speaking Part 4. Task 2:

Hi Lena, it's Rita. I wasn't able to get through so I decided to leave a voice message. I've found two pictures for our project "The best weather for your holidays". I'm going to describe them to you and express my opinion on some points.

I believe the pictures are perfectly suitable because they show children enjoying their time in different weather conditions. In the first picture, there's a girl swimming in the sea with a swim ring. She's smiling. In the second photo, there are some children sliding down the slope on the snow. I cannot see their faces but I believe they are enjoying it a lot. The difference between the pictures is in the time of year the children are having fun during their holidays: in summer and in winter.

For me, having fun in hot and cold weather has its own advantages. You can enjoy your time outdoors for a very long time when the weather is warm. Cold weather gives you a lot of energy, it's really pleasant to breathe with fresh cold air.

I can also mention some disadvantages of the two types of weather. When it's hot, you may have sunstroke sunstroke if you don't wear a hat. You may get cold if the weather is chilly, which is really uncomfortable.

Speaking about my preferences, I'd choose to have a holiday in hot weather. I like going to hot countries even in autumn or winter because I really like the sun and getting a deep suntan.

That's all about the pictures and my opinion. Call me back.

Writing an email. Task 2

You have received an email message from your English-speaking pen-friend Mary:

From: Mary@mail.uk
To: Russian_friend@ege.ru
Subject: <i>Natural disasters</i>
<i>...My uncle lives in Wales and last week his house was ruined by a flood. What do you think are the most horrible natural disasters? Which of them are typical of the place where you live? What can people do to protect themselves from them?</i>
<i>My geography teacher got the annual award "Best teacher of the year", I'm so happy about it!</i>

Write an email to Mary.

In your message:

- answer her questions;
- ask **3 questions** about her geography teacher.

Write **100–140 words**.

Remember the rules of email writing.

Writing Task 38. Writing a problem and a solution

The problem and solution do not usually refer to the data you describe and compare (this is a common mistake, which usually leads to logical mistakes). This point in a plan usually refers to something connected with the topic but may be on a wider or narrower topic. For example, the task could be about teenagers but the problem and solution are about people in general and vice versa.

Think about the following problems and solutions:

1. Outline three problems that can arise with protecting animals and suggest ways of solving them.

2. Outline three problem that can arise with life in large cities for teenagers and suggest ways of solving them.

Answers for Writing an email. Task 1

6 4 8 12 2 7 5 13 10 14 1 9 3 11

Dear Sean,

Thanks for your email. I'm always happy to get a letter from you.

You asked me about weather in Russia. Well, it's different in different parts of the country. I live in Moscow and the climate isn't very severe here. It's up to 30 degrees Celsius in summer and people usually wear light clothes such as shorts, T-shirts, dresses or light jeans. In winter it could be cold, sometimes minus 25. People wear warm winter coats, trousers, woolen dresses and sweaters. In Russia we build houses with good insulation to be protected from the cold and wind. Governments build dams to protect some areas from flooding.

Great news that you're going to the cinema. What film are you going to see? How long is it? Who are the lead actors?

Write back soon.

Best wishes,

Lena

135 words

Sample answers for writing an email. Task 2:

Dear Mary,

Thanks for your email. Great to hear from you again.

It's a pity your uncle has lost his home. I believe that floods and volcano eruptions are the most horrible natural disasters. They are not typical of the place where I live because there are no mountains here and not many rivers. It doesn't rain much either. In the areas where there are floods and volcanic eruptions people should always have a car to leave the area very quickly if these natural disasters happen.

By the way, it's so great that your teacher won that prize. Is your geography teacher a man or a woman? How old is he\she? How long has he\she taught geography?

Hope to hear from you soon.

Love,
Dasha

125 words

Writing Task 38. Writing a problem and a solution

3. Look at the following paragraphs to these problems and solutions written by an expert. Are they written in a similar way? What are the differences?

Although animal protection programmes exist in most civilised countries, there is a problem that may arise. Animal protection requires a huge investment and does not bring any profit, so there is usually a lack of funds. To solve the problem schools and universities should organise volunteering activities to raise students' awareness of this issue so that they start helping animals for free. In this case less money will be required to maintain such programmes.

Living in large cities is more convenient in comparison to living in the country. However, such a life can be a cause of different problems for teenagers. For most of them, it can lead to different health problems such as asthma, since there is not enough fresh air in megapolises. To solve the problem teenagers should spend their summer in the country where ecology is usually much better.

4. Read the text. What problem has the author outlined? What do they suggest?

These days, air pollution in cities is a big problem. One way to counter this is for more people to use public transport. But, would this really help? Firstly, by taking public transport, we can vastly reduce the number of vehicles emitting pollution on the roads. If 50 people take a bus instead of driving separate cars, there will be 49% fewer vehicles on the road. This will make a huge difference to the amount of air pollution. Secondly, with fewer vehicles on the road, travel time will be shorter. This means that people won't be spending as much time with their engines on every day. This will help people to get to work quicker as well as improving air quality.

5. What is the problem with air pollution in your area? Is there a solution? (write a paragraph)

Suggested answers for Writing Task 38.
Writing a problem and a solution:

Protecting animals:

1. A lack of funds - organise volunteering activities
2. Some animals cannot be bred in captivity - organize sanctuaries where such animals could live and feel free
3. Some animals such as whales or those living in remote areas are difficult to track to figure out whether protection measures work. Special digital trackers should be attached to such animals so that they could be tracked via satellites.

Life in large cities for teenagers:

1. Health problems such as asthma - spend their summer in the country
2. Friends could live in different parts of the city. It may take hours to get to their place - see each other in city centres, meet each other half way to save time
3. Teenagers in cities tend to be more reserved and do not have many friends - schools have to organize social activities for teenagers where student could meet and make new friends

Paragraphs written by an expert:

They are not written in a similar way.

The beginning of the first paragraph is made via a concession clause (although...). It states that there is a problem. The second paragraph begins with a comparison of life in large cities and the country and the advantage of living in the former place. Only then is the problem introduced.

Text:

A problem of air pollution. Solution: to use public transport

Air pollution. Suggested answer:

One of the problems that worries citizens of my area is air pollution. It is sometimes difficult to breathe, especially when it is hot. Cars produce a lot of fumes and there are still working factories in my city. People suffer from allergies because of this. To solve the problem, the government should encourage people to use public transport and electric cars by special discount programmes for public transport fees and subsidies for buying electric cars.

Writing Task 38. Task 2 (Sample answer on page 174)

Imagine that you are doing a project on **the main environmental problems in Zetland**. You have found some data on the subject – the results of a survey (see the table below).

Comment on the survey data and give your opinion on the subject of the project.

The survey question: What are the main environmental problems in your country?	
Problems	Number of respondents (%)
Deforestation	32
Population growth	25
Industrialisation	17
Road construction	16
Urbanisation	10

Write **200-250 words**.

Use the following plan:

- make an opening statement on the subject of the project;
- select and report 2-3 facts;
- make 1-2 comparisons where relevant and give your comments;
- outline a problem that can arise with climate change and suggest a way of solving it;
- conclude by giving and explaining your opinion on humans' impact on climate change.

Real-life Task 38

Quick questionnaire

Follow the QR-code link or the link below. Answer the question about a weather phenomenon you dislike and see the results of other students.

Take a picture of the results and write your data description. Compare two figures and give a comment. Since it's a real-life opinion poll, the results change all the time, so you can do the task again in a while. Keep in mind that the respondents are Russian teenagers.

Address the following:

- outline a problem that can arise with some of the weather phenomena and suggest a way of solving it;
- conclude by giving and explaining your opinion on the importance of weather forecast.

<https://forms.gle/hVRoTXscRvuFUrJVA>

